

CLAUDE CODE · ~/.CLAUDE/SKILLS

My Skills

a field guide — what each one does, and when it fires.

Four personal Claude Code skills, mirrored to `~/skills` and version-controlled. Each is invoked automatically when its trigger appears, or on request by name.

// 01

manifest

Plan before code; a living task doc.

// 02

design

Editorial-technical frontend aesthetic.

// 03

stacked

Decompose into reviewable layers.

// 04

ian-illustrations

Xiaohei hand-drawn article art.

manifest

write the plan before the code, then keep it honest.

WHAT IT DOES

A living markdown doc per non-trivial task at `tasks/<slug>/manifest.md` — capturing the **problem, decisions, exploration findings, plan, open questions, test & rollout plans, and a final review**. Updated continuously as the work progresses, so the deliverable is the code *and* the doc that explains it.

HOW TO USE

Fires at the **start** of a feature, migration, refactor, or any 3+ step task — “build X”, “migrate X”, “let’s plan”. At init it creates **only** `manifest.md`; `data/`, `artifacts/`, `runs/` are added *lazily* when first needed. `tasks/` is gitignored — local-only. *Not for* typos, one-line fixes, or questions.

design

paper, not screen. one surgical accent.

WHAT IT DOES

A personal **editorial-technical** frontend aesthetic: warm paper canvas, a single rust accent, literary serif display paired with monospace metadata, dot-grid texture, and hairline schematic cards. Reads like a typeset spec sheet — and overrides generic AI defaults (Inter-on-white, purple gradients).

HOW TO USE

Applies to **any** UI, page, dashboard, component, mockup, or slide — even when not explicitly invoked. Six commitments: *paper not screen · one accent · mono as metadata · italic as emphasis · hairlines not boxes · number everything*. Bundled: `references/tokens.md`, `references/components.md`, `examples/this-style-example.html`. (This guide is rendered in it.)

stacked

small, dependent, independently reviewable.

WHAT IT DOES

Breaks a large, complex, or risky change into a **stack of small units** — each with one responsibility, each building on the layer below — so every PR answers a single reviewable question instead of arriving as one unreadable diff.

HOW TO USE

Fires on build / implement / refactor work that **spans multiple layers** (models, storage, logic, tools, API, UI), or “stacked PRs / stack this”. Implement *bottom-up*: one branch & PR per layer, layer N targets layer N-1. Example:

`examples/orchestrator-front-door.md`. Pairs with **manifest**’s Stack section.

ian-illustrations

one image, one idea — hand-drawn.

WHAT IT DOES

Ian's **Xiaohei (小黑)** illustration system: reads an article's cognitive anchors and turns them into **16:9 hand-drawn image-gen prompts** — pure white background, black line art, sparse English annotations, one accent flow color, the little deadpan creature performing the core action.

HOW TO USE

Give it the **article content**. It returns a *shot list*, then one prompt per illustration (choosing from 8 composition structures), then a QA self-check. Prompts & annotations are always in English. Example: [examples/hub-illustrations/](#) — prompts plus four rendered PNGs.